

Jianxuan Lei

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EDUCATION

University of Minnesota Twin Cities <i>Ph.D. in Business Administration (Work and Organizations), Carlson School of Management</i> <i>Advisor: Dr. John W. Budd</i>	Minneapolis, MN May 2027
University of Minnesota Twin Cities <i>Master of Human Resources and Industrial Relations</i>	Minneapolis, MN May 2021
Renmin University of China <i>Bachelor of Business Administration</i> <i>Visiting student, Aalto University, Finland in 2017</i>	Beijing, China June 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I study human resource management and industrial relations, with a focus on how workers and unions, employers, and institutional environments jointly shape employment relations. My research follows two broad lines of inquiry. First, I examine the causes of union decline and the consequences of collective employee voice. This work investigates how employer resistance to unions and salient labor disputes (e.g., the 1981 PATCO strike) shape workers' willingness and ability to organize, as well as how collective action (e.g., strikes) affects worker well-being. Second, I study workplace inclusion, focusing on how unions and other forms of collective representation can promote or constrain inclusion across gender, immigration status, and other social identities. Across these areas, my research considers implications for workers, unions, and managers, including how organizations respond to employee voice, manage workplace conflict, support worker well-being, and build inclusive employment relationships. Methodologically, I draw on insights from economics, sociology, psychology, and organizational theory to inform rigorous quantitative analysis.

PUBLICATIONS

Lei, Jianxuan. "The importance of legal strength for trade unions: Theory and evidence from China." *Industrial Relations: A Journal of Economy and Society* 63.4 (2024): 491-511. <https://doi.org/10.1111/irel.12351>.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Lei, Jianxuan. "From gender antagonism to inclusive solidarity? Trade union membership and attitudes towards women's employment." Status: minor revision at *Industrial Relations: A Journal of Economy and Society*.

Lei, Jianxuan. "Normalizing opposition to labor unions: The impact of the 1981 PATCO strike on union organizing." Status: working paper (job market paper; target journal: *Administrative Science Quarterly*).

Lei, Jianxuan, Xin Meng, and Xueyu Wang. "Do you hear the people sing? The impact of strikes on workers' mental health." Status: working paper (target journal: *British Journal of Industrial Relations*).

Lei, Jianxuan. "Contested solidarity: Trade union membership and immigration attitudes in Europe." Status: manuscript development.

Lei, Jianxuan. "Union representation roles and job performance: Evidence from professional men's and women's basketball." Status: data collection.

PRESENTATIONS

Lei, Jianxuan. May 2026. "Normalizing Opposition to Labor Unions: The Impact of the 1981 PATCO Strike on Union Organizing." Labor and Employment Relations Association 78th Annual Meeting, Minneapolis, MN.

Lei, Jianxuan, Xin Meng, Xueyu Wang. June 2025. "Do you hear the people sing? The impact of strikes on workers' mental health." Labor and Employment Relations Association 77th Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA.

Lei, Jianxuan. Feb 2025. “Normalizing opposition to labor unions: The impact of the 1981 PATCO strike on union organizing” Work and Organizations Department Student Workshop Series. Minneapolis, MN.

Lei, Jianxuan, Xin Meng, Xueyu Wang. Nov 2024. “Do you hear the people sing? The impact of strikes on workers’ mental health.” Work and Organizations Department Work in Progress Seminar. Minneapolis, MN.

Lei, Jianxuan, Xin Meng, Xueyu Wang. Nov 2024. “Do you hear the people sing? The impact of strikes on workers’ mental health.” Work and Organizations Department Student Workshop Series. Minneapolis, MN.

Lei, Jianxuan. June 2024. “Contested Solidarity: Trade Union Membership and Immigration Attitudes in Europe.” Labor and Employment Relations Association 76th Annual Meeting, New York, NY.

Lei, Jianxuan. Oct 2023. “Contested Solidarity: Trade Union Membership and Immigration Attitudes in Europe.” Work and Organizations Department Student Workshop Series. Minneapolis, MN.

Lei, Jianxuan. Aug 2023. “Trade union membership and women’s right to work: From gender antagonism to inclusive solidarity?” Carlson School of Management Multi-Disciplinary Academic Research Summit. Minneapolis, MN.

Lei, Jianxuan. June 2023. “Trade union membership and women’s right to work: From gender antagonism to inclusive solidarity?” Labor and Employment Relations Association 75th Annual Meeting. Detroit, MI.

Lei, Jianxuan. May 2022. “Trade union membership and women’s right to work: The complex dynamics between gender, labor, and politics in Europe.” The Centre for Employment Relations, Innovation and Change Doctoral Conference, University of Leeds, UK (Remote).

TEACHING AND OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Independent Instructor for Undergraduate Students	Minneapolis, MN
<i>University of Minnesota Twin Cities</i>	<i>Spring 2024</i>

HRIR 3071 Union Organizing and Labor Relations
 HRIR 3072 Collective Bargaining and Dispute Resolution

Teaching Assistant	Minneapolis, MN
<i>University of Minnesota Twin Cities</i>	<i>2021-Present</i>

CMBA 5853 Negotiation Strategies (2026 Fall)
 MGMT 6004 Negotiation Strategies (2026 Fall)
 HRIR 6502 Total Compensation (2026 Fall)
 HRIR 6501 Compensation and Benefits (2025 Spring)
 HRIR 6701 Labor Relations and Collective Bargaining (2025 Spring, 2023 Spring)
 HRIR 6801 Master of Human Resources and Industrial Relations Practicum (2024 Fall, 2022 Fall)
 MBA 6111 Organizational Behavior (2024 Fall)
 HRIR 5662 Personnel Economics (2022 Fall, 2022 Spring)
 MGMT 4040 Negotiation Strategies (2022 Fall)
 HRIR 3071 Union Organizing and Labor Relations (2022 Spring)
 HRIR 5442 Performance Management (2021 Fall)
 MCOM 5400 Managerial Communication (2021 Fall)

Research Assistant	Minneapolis, MN
<i>University of Minnesota Twin Cities</i>	

Project on racial equality in U.S. medical schools (2026-2027, supervised by Dr. Thomas Helgerman)
 Project on gender equality, political parties, and industrial relations (2024–2025, supervised by Dr. John Budd)
 Project on the impact of parental union status on children’s life course (2021–2023, supervised by Dr. John Budd)
 Project on the ideological distribution of labor union members (2019–2020, supervised by Dr. John Budd)

SERVICE & ACTIVITIES

Refereeing: (journal) ILR Review; (conference) Labor and Employment Relations Association (LERA) 77th Annual Meeting.

LERA 78th Annual Meeting Ph.D. Consortium	Minneapolis, MN
<i>Co-ordinator</i>	<i>May 2026</i>

Co-developed the consortium agenda; coordinated invitations and communication with student participants and guest speakers; managed administrative logistics, including reimbursements and participant feedback.

Carlson School Cross-Department Practice Job Talks

Organizer

Minneapolis, MN

July 2025

Organized and hosted five interdisciplinary practice job talks for Ph.D. students across Carlson departments; coordinated scheduling, venues, and participant invitations; facilitated audience feedback and discussion.

Labor Organizer and Bargaining Committee Member

UMN Graduate Labor Union - UE 1105

Minneapolis, MN

2022-2024

Organized graduate workers around unionization, pay and fees, workplace safety, abuse and discrimination, and quality of work; represented graduate workers in the first collective bargaining with the university.

AWARDS & HONORS

2025, University of Minnesota Graduate School Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship (\$25,000)

2025, Carlson School of Management Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship (\$7,500)

2024, Work and Organizations Department Dare to Care Research Award (\$1,500)

2023-2025, Carlson School Ph.D. Student Conference Travel Fellowship (approx. \$3,000 in total)

2022, Labor and Employment Relations Association Best Student Paper (\$300)

2022–2025, Carlson School Summer Research Fellowship (\$5000 each summer)

2021–2025, Carlson School Ph.D. Student Fellowship (approx. \$4,500 per semester)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Labor and Employment Relations Association (Member, 2021-Present)

Academy of Management (Member, 2025-Present)

REFERENCES

[Dr. John W. Budd](#) (Advisor)

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Department of Work and Organizations
Carlson School of Management
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[Dr. Tom VanHeuvelen](#)

Associate Professor
Department of Sociology
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[Dr. Thomas Helgerman](#)

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